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IAN S. CHADD

Department of Economics
Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
3208 Russell Sage Laboratory
110 8th St, Troy, NY 12180

Email: ian.chadd@gmail.com
Website: ianchadd.com

Academic Positions

August 2019 - Assistant Professor of Economics, Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

Education

2019 Ph.D. in Economics, University of Maryland, College Park
Thesis committee: Erkut Ozbay (chair), Emel Filiz-Ozbay, Yusufcan Masatlioglu

2013 BA in Economics and Mathematics, *summa cum laude*, Wittenberg University

Research Areas

LGBTQ+ Economics, Gender, Limited Attention, Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics

Job Market Paper

"Discrimination in the Large and Small," with Mike Shor.
Abstract: Hiring managers routinely choose from applicant pools ranging from a handful of candidates to hundreds. Yet, most experiments on discrimination examine choices between just two candidates, leaving unexplored the question of how the size of the choice set affects discrimination. In a pre-registered experiment, subjects act as managers, choosing candidates from pools of either four or sixteen. Candidate gender is displayed directly while ability is available only through a signal that is harder to process. Across all subjects, increasing the number of candidates shifts the female hiring rate from 52 to 49 percent, a pro-female bias in small pools that disappears in large ones. A pro-male bias emerges in larger pools among male managers, managers with high search costs, and managers with hostile attitudes toward women. Click-level search data shows managers reveal men's and women's ability signals equally often and in roughly the same order in both pool sizes. Instead, discrimination arises in how managers use the revealed information. The probability that a manager hires a woman when she is the best considered candidate decreases in large choice pools. Sequential search, satisficing, and rational inattention with a gender-biased prior each predict the direction of the main effect, but are inconsistent with the search data. The evidence is consistent with managers switching decision heuristics as pools grow, relying on a pro-male bias only in large choice sets.

Publications

1. "Reciprocity Under Risk" with Erkut Ozbay, *conditionally accepted at the Journal of the Economic Science Association*.
2. "Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity," with Billur Aksoy, Brit Grosskopf, and Boon Han Koh, *forthcoming in Handbook of Gender and Experimental Economics, to be published by Edward Elgar, Editors Maria Cubel & Christiane Schwieren*.
3. "Choosing to Search: Choice with a Default Option," with Emel Filiz-Ozbay and Erkut Ozbay, *Experimental Economics* 28, 237 253 (2025). [Funded by National Science Foundation (NSF) Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (DDRIG)]

4. "Competitiveness at the Intersection of Gender and Sexual Orientation" with Billur Aksoy. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 233 (2025). [Partially funded by RPI HASS (Humanities, Arts, and Social Sciences) Flash Grant]
5. "Sexual Identity, Gender, and Anticipated Discrimination in Prosocial Behavior," with Billur Aksoy and Boon Han Koh, *European Economic Review* 154, 14427 (2023).
6. "Random Network Consideration: Theory and Experiment," *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization* 211, 251 - 269 (2023). [Funded by NSF DDRIG]
7. "The Relevance of Irrelevant Information," with Emel Filiz-Ozbay and Erkut Ozbay, *Experimental Economics* 24, 985 - 1018 (2021).

Working Papers

8. "Does Domain Preference Explain Gender Gaps in Self-Evaluation?" with Billur Aksoy and Boon Han Koh, *revise and resubmit at the European Economic Review*.
9. "Effect of Feedback on Beliefs about Self-Ability" with Elif Osun.
10. "Revisiting Gender Differences in Economic Behavior Amidst the COVID-19 Pandemic," with Billur Aksoy and Elif Osun. [Funded by NSF Rapid Response Research (RAPID) grant]

Work in Progress

11. "The Social Acceptability of Sexual Assault: A Study of Victim Identity, Hypersexualization, and the Willingness to Condemn Perpetrators," with Kennedy Johnston.
12. "Non-Monetary Incentives and Traffic Congestion" with Erkut Ozbay and Santiago Velez-Ferro.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

2020	National Science Foundation (NSF) RAPID (SES-2031465 & SES-2031446) with Billur Aksoy and Erkut Ozbay. $99,999.
2019	Russell Sage Foundation, Small Projects Grant, "The Effects of Gendered Virtual Assistants," with Kirby Nielsen and Siri Isaksson
2019	RPI HASS Flash Grant, "LGBT Individuals and Economic Preferences", with Billur Aksoy
2018	NSF DDRIG, "Random Network Consideration: Theory and Experiment"
2016	Jacob K. Goldhaber International Travel Grant, UMD

Research Employment

2015 - 2019	Graduate Assistant Director, Experimental Economics Lab, University of Maryland, College Park
2015 - 2018	Research Assistant for Prof. Erkut Ozbay, University of Maryland, College Park
2013	Research Assistant for Prof. David Wishart, Wittenberg University
2012	Lab Intern, Center for the Study of Neuroeconomics, George Mason University

Courses Taught

Fall 2022 - present	Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (RPI)
Spring 2020 - present	Economic Models of Decision Making (RPI)
Fall/Spring 2019 - present	Behavioral Economics (RPI)
Summer 2015, Winter 2016, Summer 2016	Mathematics For Economists (UMD)

Invited Talks

2026	Williams College (planned); Middlebury College (planned); Bowdoin College (planned); Bates College (planned)
2024	University of Vermont, George Mason University, University of Maryland
2023	TAMU Agricultural Economics, University of Connecticut
2022	Union College, UMass Amherst Applied Micro Workshop
2020	American Economic Association (AEA) LGBT Virtual Seminar Series
2019	Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, University of Bristol, CERGE-EI, Florida State University, University College Dublin, Claremont McKenna College, Binghamton University

Conference Presentations

2026	New England Experimentalist Workshop (NEEW) - UMass Amherst; Liberal Arts College Behavioral and Experimental Economics Workshop - Colby College; Economic Science Association (ESA) World Meetings - LA; ESA North America Meetings - UVA (planned)
2025	New England Experimentalist Workshop (NEEW) - UMass Amherst
2024	New England Experimentalist Workshop (NEEW) - UConn
2023	New England Experimentalist Workshop (NEEW) - Middlebury
2022	New England Experimentalist Workshop (NEEW) - Amherst; ESA World Meetings - Boston; INFORMS Advanced Decision Analysis Conference - DC; SABE Conference, Lake Tahoe; BEEMA6 - Camden; ESA NA Meetings - Santa Barbara
2021	American Economic Association (AEA) Meetings (virtual); ESA World Meetings (virtual); ESA NA Meetings - Tucson; Southern Economics Association Meetings, Houston
2020	ESA World Meetings (virtual); Southern Economics Association Meetings (virtual)
2019	ESA North America Meetings, LA; Southern Economic Association, Fort Lauderdale
2018	ESA North America Meetings, Antigua, Guatemala
2016	6th Xiamen University International workshop on Experimental Economics

Service

Department (Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute):
Graduate Program Committee (2019 - present); Co-Director (2020 - 2022)
Department Seminar Coordinator (2021 - 2025)
Supervisor, RPI Undergraduate Research Program

Institute (Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute):
LGBTQ+ Task Force – co-led design and implementation of RPI's first campus-wide LGBTQ+ climate survey
Dissertation Committee Member, Department of Cognitive Science

Profession:
Mentor, AEA Committee on the Status of LGBTQ+ Individuals in the Economics Profession, formal mentorship program
Panel and event organizer, Economic Science Association (ESA) conferences
Participant, AEA LGBTQ+ Virtual Seminar Series
Panelist, National Science Foundation (NSF) review panels

Professional Activities

Referee:

- Bulletin of Economic Research
- Economic Inquiry
- Experimental Economics
- Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics
- Journal of Behavioral Public Administration
- Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization
- Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy
- Journal of Homosexuality
- Management Science
- National Science Foundation (NSF)
- Review of Economic Design
- Scientific Reports
- Southern Economic Journal

Personal Information

Born: December 19, 1990.
Citizenship: USA.
Languages: English (native), Chinese (proficient).